

Overnight snow camp from the Bogong Rover Chalet

Purpose

An overnight camp to give Rovers and Venturers the experience of camping in the snow, for OAS Alpine Cross Country Skiing stage 5.

Participants

Rovers, Venturers and Leaders staying at the Bogong Rover Chalet. Given this snow camp starts from the Bogong Rover Chalet in winter, the participants have already demonstrated the ability to travel 11km and carry a pack on snow.

Participants to be approved by the snow camp leader and the party leader and recorded on the trip intentions form.

Leaders

The person leading the snow camp must have the Trained Participant Cross Country Patrolled or Trained Participant Show Shoeing Day Tour qualification or Trained Participant Bushwalking Extremely Difficult Tracked & Untracked Environments or higher qualification (Guide) and must have experience snow camping. Provided this plan is followed, the leader does not need to seek prior approval from the State Leader – Alpine for the camp but does need approval from the Party Leader.

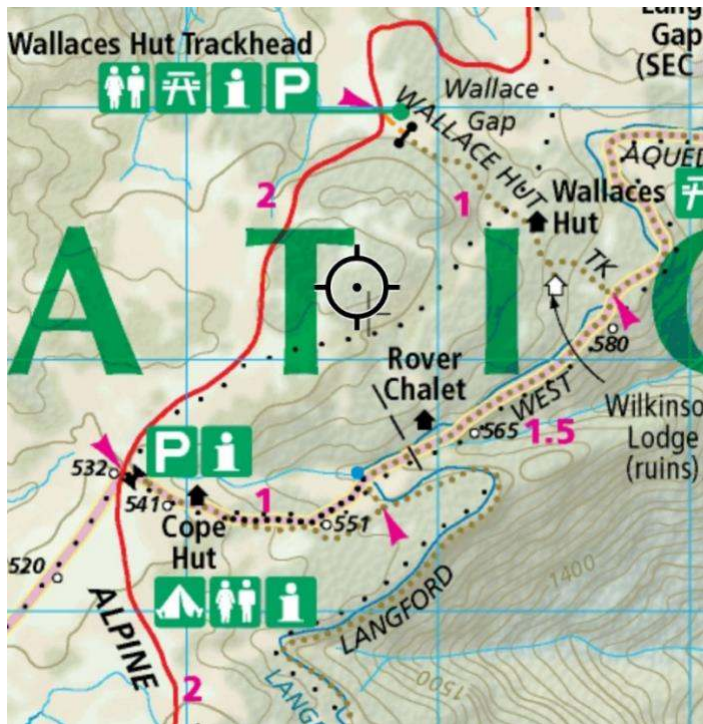
For Venturer weeks, there will be a Guide either nearby at the chalet (indirect supervision) or at the camp (direct supervision).

Location

Camping near Cope Hut or Wallaces hut . Route is either:

- Bogong Rover Chalet, Langford West Aqueduct heading West, Alpine Walking track to camping area behind Cope Hut.
- Bogong Rover Chalet, Langford West Aqueduct heading East, Wallace Hut track, camping near Wallaces Hut.

Return the following day using a similar route.



Risk Management

See separate "Risk assessment – BRC camp.xlsx"

Trip intentions form will be left at the chalet and approved by the Party Leader.

Participants will have already demonstrated their ability to travel 11km on snow carrying a pack. Given the purpose is introducing scouts to snow camping, the camping trip is intended to be suitable for inexperienced participants. To reduce risk:

- Camp location is adjacent to a hut, so the hut can be used as refuge in the event of tent failure.
- Camp location is within 2km of the chalet, to allow support from the chalet in the event of an emergency.

Trigger points for cancelling or postponing the camp:

- Bureau of Meteorology (BoM) severe weather warning (sustained winds of gale force >63km/h, blizzard, heavy rainfall). <http://www.bom.gov.au/vic/warnings/>
- BoM forecast for strong winds > 50km/h at Falls Creek. <http://www.bom.gov.au/vic/forecasts/fallscreek.shtml> or estimated wind speed > 50km/h at campsite.
- Danger Rating of "Travel Not Recommended" on the Mountain Safety Collective website, Backcountry Reports, North East Victoria. <https://mountainsafetycollective.org/backcountry-conditions-reports>

Put mobile phone and radio in a polar fleece bag and keep in a sleeping bag overnight. Batteries drain more quickly when cold. Don't sit radio or phone in the snow.

Stove needs to sit on a ground plate to prevent it tipping over in the snow as the heat of cooking melts the snow underneath. A suitable ground plate is a small flat piece of plywood or similar.

Choose to camp near Wallaces Hut if the wind forecast is stronger.

Camp near Cope Hut if wind forecast is lower. If there is difficulty in erecting the tents or pegs not staying anchored due to the wind, abandon this location while there is still time to return to the chalet, or relocate to near Wallaces Hut.

No alcohol to be consumed while camping. No alcohol to be consumed at the chalet while there is snow camping in progress, so that those at the chalet are able to assist the campers if required.

Minimum camping party size is four.

For Venturer weeks, camping party must have a minimum of two Leaders. Those remaining at the chalet must have a minimum of three Leaders, so that two are available to assist if required (assisted by another two Venturers if required to have a party of four), while one Leader remains at the chalet as coordinator.

Pay close attention to preventing hypothermia. Nights are usually colder than the more familiar daytime. Check every member of the group. Make sure they are warm enough and are wearing sufficient clothing. Exercise before going to bed to warm up, and possibly go to bed with a hot water bottle.

Contingency

Return to the chalet before dark if there is any difficulty with tents or sleeping gear.

Return to the chalet in daylight if a participant is unable to stay warm with their equipment. Tents can be recovered the following day.

Take shelter in the nearby hut if, after dark, there is tent failure or other problems that are more easily managed in a larger space.

Request assistance from the chalet if a participant is unable to ski back to the chalet (e.g. injury, hypothermia).

When returning in the morning, consider whether it is safer to wait until the ice has softened.

Emergency management

If a participant requires immediate medical attention, call 000.

If a participant requires evacuation, but it is not urgent, call the police or SES at Falls Creek to discuss possible arrangements.

Request assistance from the chalet if the emergency can be managed with additional people and/or equipment.

Contact the chalet if there is any emergency.

Consider whether to manage an injured or incapacitated person without moving, or move to the nearby hut, or transport back to the nearby chalet.

Rescue equipment available at the chalet includes Akja rescue sled, snowshoes, roll up stretcher, blankets, sleeping bag, tarpaulin.

If a person cannot walk back to the chalet, contact the chalet and arrange for them to bring the Akja rescue sled to transport the person back to the chalet.

If emergency services are called, or a person requires immediate medical treatment, you must contact the Scouts Victoria Emergency Line 03 8543 9877. A Scouts Victoria incident report will need to be submitted within 48 hours of the end of the trip. Keep notes to assist with preparing this incident report. The chalet warden Matt Anderson [REDACTED] should also be notified.

Emergency numbers

Bogong Rover Chalet [REDACTED]

Bogong Rover Chalet Warden Matt Anderson [REDACTED]

Scouts Victoria Emergency Line 03 8543 9877

Scouts Victoria State Leader Alpine, Peter Robinson [REDACTED]

FOR ALL EMERGENCIES CALL 000

Ski Patrol 03 5758 3502

Search & Rescue 03 5758 3213

Falls Creek Medical Centre 03 5758 3238

Mount Beauty Medical Centre 03 5758 3400

Falls Creek Police Station 03 5758 3424

SES at Windy Corner 03 5758 3432 or 13 25 00.

Hospitals:

- Alpine Health Mount Beauty, 2-8 Hollonds St, Mount Beauty, 03 5754 3500.
- Northeast Health Wangaratta, 35-57 Green St, Wangaratta 03 5722 5111. 24-hour emergency department.
- Albury Wodonga Health, 53-81 Vermont St, Wodonga, 02 6051 7111. 24-hour emergency department.

Equipment and Logistics

Date: to be chosen by Party Leader based on weather and experience of participants.

Weather: Alpine. Weather forecast to be checked to make sure it is suitable for beginner snow camping. It is recommended to postpone if it is raining (easy to get wet and cold, not a good experience). See further details under Risk Management section.

Food:

Breakfast: Eat at Chalet.

Lunch: Eat at chalet, or take standard chalet touring lunch (e.g. bread, biscuits, cheese, salami, spreads)

Dinner: lightweight hike food to be brought by participants. Standard chalet dinners aren't suitable for cooking on a hike stove.

Breakfast: Cereal and milk from the chalet.

Lunch: Standard chalet lunch.

Snacks: Scroggin brought by participants.

Extras: Cup of soup, hot chocolate.

Environmental impact:

Given burying human waste is difficult when the ground is covered by snow:

- Camp site will be near toilets.
- Go to toilet before you leave the chalet.
- Carry bio-degradable poo bags that will break down in a pit toilet, for use in an emergency. Do not dispose of these in a septic system. Do not flush at the chalet – it will block the system.

Don't ski over exposed vegetation.

Communication Plan:

Participants to take UHF CB radio from the chalet and a mobile phone. A radio schedule will be agreed and recorded on the trip intention form. For example, camping party to call the chalet between 5 and 6pm, and again between 7 and 8am, using radio or phone.

A copy of the emergency numbers to be taken by the camping party:

Equipment:

Participants will need to bring extra gear for camping and should prepare for this before arriving at the chalet.

Start with chalet packing list, then add following gear/changes. Some items are already at the chalet, some you will need to bring.

- 4-season tent with snow pegs (chalet may have some – check beforehand)
- Closed cell mat (8 available at the chalet)
- Shovel (chalet has 6)
- UHF CB radio (chalet)
- Polar fleece bag for storing radio and mobile phone overnight inside your sleeping bag (chalet, stored with radios)
- Lunch/breakfast food (chalet)

You will need to bring these:

- Sleeping pad (sum of R values of mat and pad to be 5 or more)
- Sleeping bag with a 0 degrees Celsius comfort rating or better. -5C is better.
- Stove + ground plate + fuel suitable for alpine temperatures
- Cookpot
- Plastic plate, cup, cutlery
- Water bottle suitable for use with hot water

- Food for dinner

This will add an extra 1.5-2kg to the pack weight for the trip into the chalet if using a tent and mat from the chalet (if available), or 3-4kg if also carrying tent and mat.

Cooking must not take place in a Bogong Rover Chalet tent or a tent vestibule.

Constructing a designated camp kitchen is recommended.

If snow camping tents are available at the chalet, the Party Advisor is responsible for issuing the tents and recording the details in the equipment logbook, checking the tents on return and recording their return and any defects in the equipment logbook.

Preparation:

Select participants.

Complete relevant OAS Alpine Plan> statements before camping.

Briefing for participants:

- route plan
- emergency plan
- group/individual gear
- environmental impact
- selecting a camp site in the snow
- erecting a tent in the snow
- how to stay warm while snow camping

Check participant gear.

Get weather reports:

<http://www.bom.gov.au/vic/warnings/>

<http://www.bom.gov.au/vic/forecasts/fallscreen.shtml>

Check the alpine travel report for North East Victoria:

<https://mountainsafetycollective.org/backcountry-conditions-reports>

Trip intention form completed and approved by party leader.

Distribute group gear.

Review

Send a review of your trip to the Bogong Chalet Management Group.

What changes would you make to this trip plan?

This plan approved by State Leader – Alpine for 2024 season, and to be reviewed before 2025 season.

Amended 15 June 2024 to require no consumption of alcohol while participants out skiing.